

Warmth, Stick, Law

One ADAP employment rule — three official documents — three very different messages

Every Albertan moved to the Alberta Disability Assistance Program (ADAP) is told the same thing: part of receiving the benefit means taking part in employment services. But that single requirement is written three different ways across three government documents. Read side by side, the reassurance shrinks and the power broadens at each step — from the welcome brochure, to the letter in the mailbox, to the regulation that ultimately governs the benefit. What follows is the documented language of the government’s own materials.

WARMTH the welcome brochure	STICK the letter in your mailbox	LAW the regulation that governs it
1 Do you have to take part?		
Framed as your own path. You “define your goals based on what you are ready for,” with support “as you make progress.”	Now an instruction. <i>“It is important that you respond.”</i> Participation is part of receiving the benefit.	Enforceable. The director may act on your benefit based on whether you take part. It is a condition, not a choice.
2 What happens if you don’t?		
The brochure never says. No loss of benefit appears anywhere in it.	The consequence appears, but stays vague: your eligibility for continued ADAP assistance <i>“may be impacted.”</i>	Named in full. The director may <i>“refuse, suspend, vary or discontinue”</i> the benefit.
3 What counts as not taking part?		
Never defined. You move toward work “when you are able.”	Only if you <i>“refuse”</i> — one deliberate word.	Far broader: <i>“refused or neglected to participate”</i> — plus refusing to <i>“seek or accept reasonable employment,”</i> or having <i>“reduced or terminated”</i> it. Neglect counts, not just refusal.
4 What if you miss a call or fall behind?		
Reassured. <i>“If you miss a call or message, that is okay... reconnect when you are able.”</i>	You must respond. <i>“It is important that you respond to Alberta Employment Connect.”</i>	The very thing the brochure waves off — <i>“neglect”</i> to participate — is itself a ground to suspend, vary or discontinue the benefit.

What changes as you move from the brochure to the law

- **The reassurance shrinks.** From “when you are able” in the brochure, to “it is important that you respond” in the letter, to enforceable conditions in the regulation.
- **The trigger broadens.** From no trigger named at all, to the single word “refuse,” to “refused or neglected” — plus failing to seek, accept, or keep reasonable employment.

- **The consequence sharpens.** From never mentioned, to the vague “may be impacted,” to the explicit power to “refuse, suspend, vary or discontinue” the benefit.

The precise point. This is not a claim that the government will cut people who cannot find work. The letter itself states the opposite: being unable to find a job after using the services does not cost a person their benefits. The documented point is narrower. The consequence is tied to *participation* — and the documents a recipient reads describe that requirement far more gently than the regulation that governs it. Someone reassured that “missing a call is okay” is never told that, in the regulation, “neglecting” to participate is a ground to discontinue the benefit. The gap between the reassurance and the rule is the documented record.

Sources — the documented record

- **Welcome to ADAP** brochure — Government of Alberta, Assisted Living and Social Services, June 2026.
- **ADAP Employment Services** letter — Government of Alberta, dated June 23, 2026. Recipient details redacted for privacy.
- **AISH General Regulation**, amended to govern ADAP — employment-participation provisions setting out when a director may refuse, suspend, vary or discontinue a benefit.

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown — Advocate

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albertadisabilitybreakdown@outlook.com